

Google to go old fashion

Larry Page, the CEO of Google said, Google will return to its startup roots, whatever that means

Facebook to acquire Snaptu

To expand its mobile services, world's largest Internet social network Facebook has agreed to buy Snaptu, an application developer for mobile devices

Bazaar

Iomega Screenplay MX

1 TB storage, but no networking

Despite holding a 1 TB storage drive in it, the MX has a very sleek form factor, and a distinct brushed aluminium finish. The front panel has a USB input port, while the side panels are completely clean. The rear panel has all AV ports.

The MX comes with 1 TB of its own storage. Users can transfer media files from USB drives on to the internal hard drive, or access media from all 3 simultaneously. The remote is extremely comfortable to use.

What is a glaring omission in the MX media player are the LAN connectivity options. Without these, users are unable

to access the media on network connected drives, transfer files from the PC to the media player or even use streaming software like the PS3 Media Server.

The video upscale quality offered by the MX media player is extremely good. Standard Definition videos were upscaled to the Full HD resolution of 1920x1080 pixels with extreme ease. The post upscale treatment ensured that the colours remain vivid, the sharpness is not lost and extra artefacts



weren't introduced. All video formats we threw at it were played back without any problems. The interface of the MX is a bit of a downer. The home screen has huge icons just laid out across the screen in a seemingly haphazard fashion.

At a price of ₹8,000, the Iomega MX HD Media player disappoints us with lack of network connectivity.

Visbal Mathur

Specifications

High Definition media player; HDMI, Composite and Component video out; Full HD (1920x1080 resolution) for videos; 1TB hard drive preinstalled; 2 USB inputs

Contact

Iomega India

Phone: 000800 440 1158

Web site: www.go.iomega.com/home

Price: ₹7,999

6.5/10

Features.....	6.0
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	7.0
Value for money.....	6.5

Specifications

AMD Phenom II Quad Core N930 processor @ 2.00GHz; 4GB RAM; 15.6 inch screen; 1366x768 HD screen resolution; ATI Mobility Radeon HD 550c graphics; 1GB dedicated graphics memory; 500GB hard drive; 3 USB ports; 1 E-Sata port; HDMI out, Windows 7 Home Premium (64-bit)

Contact

Dell India

Phone: 1800 425 4026

Web site: <http://www.dell.co.in>

Price: ₹39,990

5.5/10

Features.....	7.0
Performance.....	6.0
Build.....	6.0
Value for money.....	5.0

Dell Inspiron M501R

Quad-Core power on a budget

The Inspiron's shiny body is what will catch your attention. The lid, which can be customized in many colours, has a shine to it, despite the finish not actually being glossy. The 15.6 inch screen has well proportioned contrast to brightness levels, and images retain their sharpness. The keyboard is neither chiclet or floating, but it is extremely comfortable to use, and the big screen size allows for a dedicated number pad. What the laptop misses out on is a bunch of dedicated access buttons for media playback, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth and touchpad off.

For a machine powered by the AMD Phenom II N930 Quad Core processor (2 GHz) and 4 GB of system RAM, performance was never going to be a problem. All the benchmarks we ran on the machine indicated a very powerful setup. A lot of people will use this machine for multimedia viewing, and the

case is helped by a big screen which is quite good and inbuilt speakers that offer better than expected performance. Even at volume levels of about 70 per cent, the audio was clear, with no jarring. The battery life was disappointing (1 hour), but this was at the max performance setting.

The Dell Inspiron M510R has all the performance you'll need if you're looking to replace your desktop. In the ₹40,000 price bracket, you should also check out the HP G-series laptops. If you can extend your budget a little, the HP DV-6 range of models or the Gateway ID59C laptop might be better choices.

- Visbal Mathur

